



Fundamentals of Human Resource Management (HRM1)

Module 1: Foundations of HRM

Lesson 2: Personnel and Managerial Psychology in HRM

Lesson Notes

KMVTECHUG

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What Is Personnel Psychology?

Personnel psychology: also called industrial-organisational or I-O psychology, the study of individual and group behaviour within the workplace.

Where HRM gives an organisation its system, personnel psychology gives the science underneath it, the tools HR uses to predict, understand, and influence workplace behaviour.

Selection decisions rely on it directly. A logistics firm may use structured interviews to reduce the risk of hiring drivers who seem confident but lack real discipline.

Motivation theory drives compensation and engagement strategy. Leadership effectiveness is psychological, rooted in how people process authority, fairness, and communication. Wellbeing and stress directly affect performance, resurfacing as absenteeism or turnover if ignored.

***Reflect:** Was there a manager or supervisor you experienced where understanding their psychology would have helped you work with them better?*

Psychology in Selection, Leadership, Engagement and Wellbeing

Selection is, at its core, a psychological prediction of whether a person will perform well in a role, using structured interviews and competency based questions.

Leadership explains why some managers get genuine effort while others get only the bare minimum. A manager seen as fair and consistent tends to get more discretionary effort.

Engagement is the difference between presence and commitment. An employee can be physically present yet psychologically disengaged, doing the minimum while mentally checked out.

Wellbeing, when ignored, does not disappear. It resurfaces as absenteeism, turnover, conflict, or declining performance.

Reflect: *Of selection, leadership, engagement, and wellbeing, which do Ugandan organisations tend to invest in the least?*

Reflection: Putting Psychology and HRM Together

Lesson 1 covered the system HRM builds (recruitment, training, performance, pay, relations, planning). This lesson covered the science underneath it, why those systems succeed or fail.

A useful way to hold onto this: HRM tells you what to do. Psychology tells you why it works, or why it does not.

As this course continues, ask of any HR practice encountered: is this designed with real human behaviour in mind, or only designed to look correct on paper?